



FIFTH ANNIVERSARY

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Almost all laptops these days come equipped with Wi-Fi connectivity. And places such as airports have Wi-Fi hotspots where you can connect your laptop to go online. But not everyone knows how to set up Wi-Fi on a laptop! Here, we explain the process of setting up your laptop to be able to connect to a Wi-Fi hotspot.

We assume you have Windows XP Professional installed on your laptop, and that your laptop has inbuilt Wi-Fi. If your laptop does not have Wi-Fi capability, you can always purchase a PCMCIA Wi-Fi card and make it Wi-Fi capable (PCMCIA slots are fairly common in laptops). Some Wi-Fi cards can set themselves up automatically to detect and connect to a wireless network, but we will see how to manually set up a Wi-Fi card to connect to a wireless network.

You'll need to know a few terms, and we explain here:

■ SSID is an acronym for Service Set Identifier. The SSID is a sequence of up to 32 letters or numbers that is the ID, or name, of a wireless local area network.

■ WEP is short for Wired Equivalency Privacy. It is a security protocol for Wi-Fi networks.

■ Wi-Fi Channel: The Wi-Fi

signal range is divided into a number of smaller bands or "channels," similar to TV channels. Thus, all Wi-Fi devices on a particular network must use the same channel.

1. Before proceeding further, you need to find out the SSID, Channel, Mode and WEP key of the Wi-Fi network you're planning to connect to. Some Wi-Fi locations do not require a WEP key. The above information can be accessed from the Wi-Fi network provider's Web site, or when you purchase the access rights to the Wi-Fi network. A list of Wi-Fi hotspots in India is available at the following sites:

www.wi-fihotspotlist.com/browse/intl/2000044/

www.jiwire.com/browse-hotspot-india-in.htm

www.wi-fihotspotsdirectory.com/Wi-Fi-Hotspots-In-India-100.html

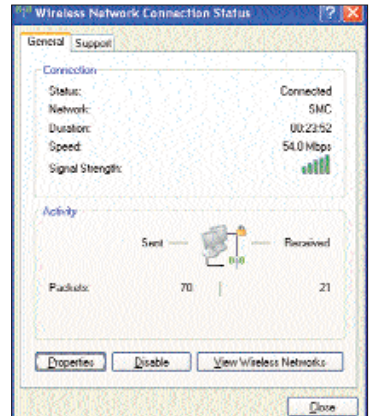
You can find contact details here to be able to access hotspots.

2. You should make sure you have a firewall and a good anti-virus program installed. This is necessary to protect your data.

3. We assume that your laptop came with the Wi-Fi card drivers installed. If it did not come with drivers for the Wi-Fi card, you may need to go to the manufacturer's Web site and download the appropriate drivers according to the model number of your Wi-Fi card or your laptop. Power on the laptop and after Windows is up and

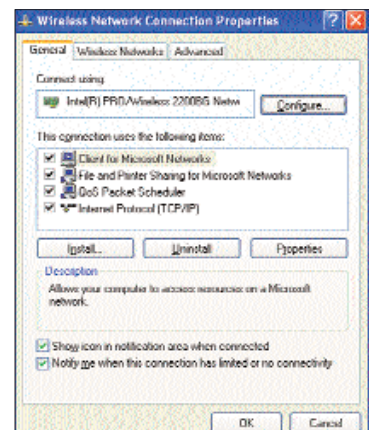
running, look for the Wi-Fi network icon in the System Tray.

4. Click on the Wi-Fi network icon, and a window showing the connection strength and session duration will appear. Click on the Properties button in this window.



The Wireless Network Connection Status

5. The Wireless Network Connection Properties window showing the name and type of network card installed will show up. Click on the Wireless Networks tab in this window.



Information about the wireless adapter

6. In the Wireless Network Connection Properties window, you will be able to view the available Wi-Fi networks in your area.

Core Duo

Intel's Core Duo mobile technology is the successor to Centrino. The key components of a Core Duo laptop are an Intel Core Duo Processor, Mobile Intel 945 Express chipset and an Intel PRO/Wireless 3945ABG network connection. The benefits of Intel Core Duo technology are excellent

performance due to the dual-core processor, higher battery life due to low power consuming components, a smaller form factor, and expanded wireless connectivity due to the newer Wi-Fi adapter, which supports a higher throughput under adverse conditions.



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